

Shopify VIP Membership App

Development Plan

This document outlines a step-by-step plan to develop a Shopify app for VIP membership with the features described.

Phase 1: Planning and Setup

1. Detailed Requirements Gathering:

- Confirm all features: Digital membership, 50% product discount for VIPs, \$29/month recurring charge.
- Product display: Three options (Regular Price, Monthly Subscription, VIP Membership).
- VIP selection: Product price changes to \$49, \$29 membership added to cart.
- VIP tagging: Shopify knows VIP status for 50% discount on all products.
- Coupons: Three \$10 coupons, one per product purchase.
- First-time VIP purchase: Product at \$39 (\$49 - \$10 coupon), \$29 membership, \$199 welcome gift (free), \$30 store credits (3 x \$10 coupons).
- Cart logic: Automatic updates for VIP selection (subscription model product at 50% off, VIP membership, free welcome gift, auto-applied coupon).
- Cart removal: If VIP product removed, coupon and welcome gift removed, main product reverts to 100% price.
- Shopify Liquid theme compatibility.
- Inbuilt coupon management (if needed).
- First-time VIP mandatory main product purchase (subscription mode).
- VIP button visibility: Hidden for VIPs.
- VIP badge and gold accent display for VIPs.
- Membership: Cannot be paused/skipped, recurring monthly, 30-day duration, benefits remain till expiry if cancelled early.

2. Technology Stack Selection:

- **Backend:** Node.js (with Express/Koa) or Ruby on Rails (with Sinatra/Padrino) for Shopify API interaction, database management, and business logic.
- **Frontend:** React/Vue/Angular for a rich user interface within the Shopify admin and potentially for custom storefront elements.

- **Database:** PostgreSQL/MongoDB for storing VIP member data, coupon usage, and subscription details.
- **Shopify APIs:** Admin API (for product, customer, order management, tagging), Storefront API (for displaying dynamic pricing/options).
- **Hosting:** Heroku, AWS, Google Cloud, or similar for app deployment.

3. Shopify Partner Account Setup:

- Create a Shopify Partner account.
- Set up a development store for testing.

Phase 2: Core App Development (Backend)

1. Authentication and Authorization:

- Implement OAuth 2.0 for secure Shopify app installation and authentication.
- Handle access tokens and refresh tokens.

2. Webhook Management:

- Set up webhooks for `customers/update`, `orders/create`, `app/uninstalled` to track VIP status changes, purchases, and app uninstallation.

3. Database Schema Design:

- `VIPMembers`: `shopify_customer_id`, `is_vip`, `membership_start_date`, `membership_end_date`, `coupons_remaining`.
- `Products`: `shopify_product_id`, `vip_price` (if different from 50% off regular).
- `Coupons`: `coupon_code`, `value`, `is_used`, `used_by_customer_id`, `used_on_order_id`.

4. Shopify API Integration (Backend Logic):

- **Customer Tagging:** Develop logic to tag customers as 'VIP' upon membership purchase and remove the tag upon cancellation/expiry.
- **Product Pricing Logic:**
 - When a customer is tagged as VIP, all products in the store should dynamically display at 50% off their regular price for that customer.
 - This might involve using Shopify Functions (if applicable for dynamic pricing at checkout) or custom storefront logic.
- **Membership Product Handling:** Create a specific Shopify product for the VIP membership (\$29/month).

- **Coupon Management:**
 - Generate and assign three \$10 coupons to new VIP members.
 - Track coupon usage (one per product).
 - Implement logic to apply one coupon automatically for the first VIP purchase.

Phase 3: Frontend Development (Shopify Theme Integration)

1. Product Page Customization (Liquid/JavaScript):

- **Display Options:** Modify product.liquid or use Shopify sections/blocks to display three buttons/options:
 -
- "Regular Price (One-Time Buy)"
 - "Monthly Subscribe"
 - "VIP Membership"
- **Dynamic Pricing Display:** When "VIP Membership" is selected, update the displayed product price to \$49.
- **Add to Cart Logic:** When the VIP button is clicked, add both the main product (at VIP price) and the \$29 VIP membership product to the cart.
- **VIP Button Visibility:** Implement logic to hide the VIP button on product pages for customers already tagged as VIP.

2. Cart Page Logic (Liquid/JavaScript):

- **Automatic Updates:**
 - When VIP option is chosen, automatically add the VIP membership product (\$29) and the free welcome gift (\$199 value) to the cart.
 - Automatically apply one \$10 coupon to the main product for the first-time VIP purchase.
- **Conditional Display:** Ensure the main product is displayed at 50% less than its regular price (subscription model) when the VIP option is active in the cart.
- **Removal Logic:** If the VIP membership product is removed from the cart, automatically remove the welcome gift and any auto-applied coupons, and revert the main product to its regular 100% price.

3. VIP Badge and Gold Accent:

- Implement Liquid/CSS to display a VIP badge and gold accent on the storefront for customers tagged as VIP.

Phase 4: Subscription and Billing

1. Shopify Billing API Integration:

- Use the Shopify Billing API to manage the \$29/month recurring charge for the VIP membership.
- Handle subscription activation, cancellation, and renewal.

2. Membership Status Management:

- Develop logic to activate/deactivate VIP status based on successful subscription payments.
- Ensure membership cannot be paused or skipped.
- Implement 30-day membership duration logic and ensure benefits remain until expiry even if cancelled early.

Phase 5: Coupon Management (Inbuilt)

1. Coupon Generation and Distribution:

- If inbuilt coupon management is chosen, develop a system to generate unique \$10 coupons.
- Distribute these coupons to new VIP members (e.g., via email or within their customer account).

2. Coupon Redemption and Tracking:

- Implement a system to track coupon redemption, ensuring only one coupon is used per product and that coupons are not combined.
- Update the `coupons_remaining` in the database.

Phase 6: Testing and Deployment

1. Unit and Integration Testing:

- Thoroughly test all backend logic (API integrations, database operations, webhooks).
- Test frontend functionality (dynamic pricing, cart logic, button interactions).

2. User Acceptance Testing (UAT):

- Test the entire user flow from a customer's perspective (VIP purchase, product discounts, coupon usage, cancellation).

3. Deployment:

- Deploy the backend application to the chosen hosting provider.
- Deploy the frontend assets (Shopify theme modifications) to the live Shopify store.

Phase 7: Post-Deployment

1. Monitoring and Maintenance:

- Set up monitoring for app performance and error logging.
- Regularly update the app to ensure compatibility with Shopify updates.

2. Customer Support:

- Provide clear instructions and support for VIP members.

This plan provides a high-level overview. Each step will require detailed design, development, and testing. Given that you are not a techie, it is highly recommended to work with experienced Shopify developers to implement this complex functionality.